

SNOWBE ONLINE Policy# D R-1

Data Retention and Disposal

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Data Retention and Disposal – Version 1.0

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Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to define how SnowBe Online retains, manages, and securely disposes of company and customer data. Effective data retention and disposal practices reduce storage risks, protect customer privacy, and ensure compliance with all regulatory, business, and contractual obligations. This policy supports SnowBe's commitment to information security and responsible data lifecycle management.

Scope

This policy applies to all SnowBe Online employees, contractors, and vendors who collect, process, store, or manage SnowBe data in any format. It covers both electronic and physical records maintained within SnowBe's AWS cloud environment, on-premise servers, removable storage, and paper archives used in corporate and retail operations.

Definitions

Archival Storage

The long-term preservation of inactive data required for legal, audit, or historical purposes.

Data Disposal

The secure and irreversible destruction of data to prevent recovery or unauthorized access.

Data Retention

The storage of information for a defined period to meet operational, legal, or compliance requirements.

Sensitive Data

Customer, employee, or company information that could cause harm or financial loss if disclosed.

Tokenization

The process of replacing sensitive data with a unique, non-reversible identifier to protect information during storage or processing.

Roles & Responsibilities

Chief Information Security Officer (CISO)

The CISO oversees SnowBe Online's information security strategy, ensuring alignment with business goals, NIST 800-53 controls, and PCI DSS compliance. This role leads risk management, approves major security initiatives, and reports the company's security posture to executive leadership.

Employees and Contractors

Employees and contractors must follow all security procedures, protect company and customer data, and report suspicious activities immediately. They are responsible for completing mandatory security awareness training and adhering to acceptable use policies.

Finance Department

Maintains transaction and audit records for the legally required retention periods and coordinates with IT for secure disposal.

IT Security Manager

The IT Security Manager implements and enforces security controls across SnowBe's AWS and on-premise systems. This role manages daily operations, coordinates vulnerability management, and ensures policy compliance through training and incident oversight.

System Administrators

System Administrators maintain secure system configurations, manage user access, and perform regular updates and backups. They support incident response efforts and ensure systems meet SnowBe's security and compliance standards.

Policy

SnowBe Online shall retain business and customer data only for as long as necessary to satisfy operational, legal, and regulatory requirements. Employees must not retain personal or company data beyond the retention period or store it in unauthorized locations such as personal drives. Payment card data must never be stored after authorization and must be encrypted or tokenized while in use. Customer purchase history will be retained for no longer than five years unless otherwise required by law. Backups and archived data must follow the same retention periods as the original data. When information reaches the end of its retention period, it shall be destroyed using approved sanitization methods such as cryptographic wiping, degaussing, or physical shredding. Data disposal activities and access logs must be reviewed quarterly by IT Security. The IT Department also must maintain verification records for at least one year. This policy will be reviewed annually and updated to align with PCI DSS and data protection standards.

Exceptions/Exemptions

Requests for exceptions must be submitted in writing to SnowBe Online's IT Security Manager for review and approval. Each request must include the business justification, defined scope, duration, and any compensating controls that will be applied. All approved exceptions will be formally documented, reviewed periodically for continued appropriateness, and remain valid for no longer than one year unless re-evaluated and re-approved.

Enforcement

Failure to follow this policy may result in disciplinary action, beginning with a verbal warning and escalating to written notice, suspension of system access, or termination of employment. Contractors and vendors who violate SnowBe Online's security or compliance requirements may have their access revoked or contracts terminated. Intentional or severe violations, especially those involving customer data or payment systems, may lead to termination and potential legal or regulatory action under applicable laws.

Version History Table

Version #	Implementation Date	Document Owner	Approved By	Description
1.0	11/3/2025	Jarred Ward	IT Security Manager	Original Draft

Citations

Pitt State - <https://www.pittstate.edu/policy/information-technology/data-retention-policy.html> (Used for Policy, Enforcement).

Pratt Institute - <https://www.pratt.edu/policies/data-retention-policy/> – (Used for Definitions, Exceptions/Exemptions)

University of Winchester - <https://www.winchester.ac.uk/media/Critical-Documents/Data-Retention-and-Deletion-Policy.pdf> (Used for Purpose, Scope, Roles & Responsibilities).